STATE SCAN

KERALA: ARC OF A RAINBOW MINISTRY *PG 22*

ODISHA: MAJHI'S TOUGH SHERIFF HAT *PG 23*



NEW BEGINNINGS Hindu prayers at the Bhojshala shrine after the HC verdict, May 16

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FAITH, HISTORY & A VERDICT

The MP court order on the sensitive Bhojshala issue sees the Hindus celebrating and the Muslims planning to appeal

By **Rahul Noronha**

A **JUDICIAL RULING ON MAY 15 SEEMS TO HAVE SETTLED**—albeit for the time being—a long-standing religious dispute in Madhya Pradesh over rights to worship at the Bhojshala temple-Kamal Maula mosque structure in Dhar district. The Indore bench of the MP High Court ruled that the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI)-protected monument was a temple—as claimed by the Hindu side—dismissing contrary claims by the Muslim group (and of late even that of a Jain grouping). Delivering the judgment, the division bench of Justices V.K. Shukla and Alok Awasthi also asked the government to make efforts to bring back an idol of Vagdevi lodged at the British Museum in London, besides allotting the Muslim group alternate land to build a mosque. The court also quashed a 2003 ASI order that had specifed days of the week for Hindus and Muslims to offer prayers at the struc-